

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 2NT

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 7 6 2

♥ J 9 5

♦ K J 9 7

♣ Q 10

♠ A K 3

♥ 10 6

♦ A 6 5 2

♣ A 8 5 4



♠ 10 9 8 4

♥ Q 8 2

♦ Q 10

♣ K J 9 7

♠ J 5

♥ A K 7 4 3

♦ 8 4 3

♣ 6 3 2

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

2♦

Pass

2♥

Pass

2NT

All Pass

2NT by North

You must find two more winners. And you have very little to work with. In fact, the only real chance you have is to establish dummy's ♥ suit.

You must find the ♥s split 3-3. Even then, with no entries in dummy outside the ♥ suit you cannot afford to play ♥ A K followed by a third one. True, the suit would be established, but you could never get to it.

So you win the first trick with your ♠K, then play a ♥, ducking in dummy.

An opponent will win the ♥, but whatever they return you win one of your Aces. Then play your last ♥ to dummy. If the suit splits you will make 4 ♥ tricks to go with your 4 other top honors.

You were very lucky to find a 3-3 ♥ split. This happens only about 40% of the time.

But if you had not made the correct plan your good fortune would have been wasted.

Partner's 2♦ bid is a transfer so you bid 2♥. Partner now bids 2NT.

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Partner is describing an invitational hand (9-10 points) with a 5-card ♥ suit. With a bare 15 points and doubleton ♥ you just pass.

East leads the ♠10 against your 2NT.

You try dummy's ♠J hopefully, but West puts on the ♠Q.

Winner List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 6

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 7 5 2
♥ A Q 6
♦ A Q 6 5 3
♣ 7 3

♠ J 3

♥ J 10 9 2

♦ J 9 8 4

♣ Q J 9

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q 9

♥ K 7 5 4

♦ K 10

♣ A 8 4 2

♠ A 10 8 6 4

♥ 8 3

♦ 7 2

♣ K 10 6 5

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

♠s. On the other hand, North might well switch to ♣s, and that would certainly be unwelcome. Finally, if you do win the first ♠ you have another stopper if you can prevent North from getting the lead. So win the first trick with the ♠K. Notice that by winning with the ♠K you keep South in the dark as to whether you or North has the ♠Q.

You need just one more trick, and either red suit might split 3-3. So is that your plan? Lead out red winners and hope?

Truthfully, that wouldn't be a terrible plan. The chance of a 3-3 split in a suit is about 36%. But since you need either of two 36% chances that comes to almost 60% (if you aren't Math oriented don't worry about it, you can trust me).

There's a safer approach though; remember you only need 4 ♦ tricks, not 5.

There is a wonderful "safety play" that will practically guarantee your contract. Enter dummy with a ♥, then play a small ♦ toward your hand and finesse with your ♦10! South may win with the ♦J, but even if he does he is the Safe Hand and cannot play a ♠ without giving you a trick. And whatever else he could play you would win and make 4 ♦ tricks. In the actual Deal the ♦ finesse actually works and you make all 5 tricks in the suit.

The only way this plan could go wrong is if South held the singleton ♦J. And if that were the case you wouldn't make the contract anyway (unless ♥s were 3-3).

You don't have enough points to be thinking about slam and you don't particularly want to play 5 ♦. So you bid 3NT and everybody passes.

The contract would be 3NT played by West.

East plays 3NT. South leads the ♠6; North plays the ♠J.

Your immediate problem is whether or not to hold up. ???

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 3 : ♦ = 3 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 8

There is some merit in a holdup. North is likely to have just 2 ♠s, so a holdup would exhaust his cards in the suit. If he later got the lead he would have no